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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying to register with Ryder Reid Legal for temporary corporate paralegal placements. My background spans a year-long placement at BCLP, a data privacy advisory role at Q-Legal and ongoing casework at Citizens Advice, and I am looking to build focused corporate experience ahead of a training contract.

At BCLP I spent six months supporting an international arbitration team, where I worked on a complex investment arbitration, reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions, drafted procedural orders and procedural histories, and amended sections of the Claimant's memorial. Shortly before a significant deadline I became the only junior on the team, which meant coordinating documents, tracking outstanding actions and communicating directly with the client about required materials. That experience gave me a clear picture of what managing a live matter under real pressure looks like, and the feedback I received from the partner and associate at the end of the placement was that my work was comparable to that of a newly qualified solicitor. My second rotation, in Real Estate Disputes, added experience preparing electronic bundles, supporting skeleton arguments and handling court filings across several matters with competing deadlines.

Outside BCLP, my Adobe internship involved reviewing and amending software licensing agreements, assessing contractual risk, and liaising across sales, legal and international teams to reconcile commercial objectives with legal requirements. That cross-functional work sits closest to the kind of transactional support corporate teams need, and it is the part of my background I am most keen to develop further.

Following the A&O Shearman open day in August 2026, where I attended sessions on private equity and finance work, I completed a Coursera course on private equity covering fund structures, leverage and exit strategies, and worked through the Clifford Chance real estate finance virtual programme. Those steps were deliberate: I wanted to understand the commercial mechanics behind the legal work before applying for roles in that area, not simply state an interest in corporate law.

Temporary placements through a specialist agency are the right next step for me because they would let me test different corporate environments and practice areas quickly, which is more useful at this stage than a single fixed role. I would welcome the chance to discuss what placements you currently have available.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva